

Saber Khani

Contact Information

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Research Interests

Collective Behavior and Social Movements, Political Sociology, Global and Transnational Sociology, Computational Social Science, Quantitative Methods, Global Middle East and North Africa (MENA).

Education

Ph.D. in Sociology <i>Boston College</i>	Sep 2021 - July 2027 (exp) Boston, USA
M.Sc Sociology <i>Boston College</i>	Sep 2019 - May 2021 Boston, USA
B.S. Sociology <i>Tehran University</i>	June 2016 Tehran, Iran

Publications Peer-reviewed journal articles

Vogelsang, Eric, Sara Moorman, Alan Mijares, Zackary Zanolli, Reza Tayari Ash-tiani, and **Saber Khani**. 2025. “Older Adult Social Participation and Cognition: Illustrating Survey and Measurement Heterogeneity Across Studies.” *Research on Aging*.

Khani, Saber and Sara Moorman. 2025. “Beyond the Classroom: How High School Extracurricular Activities Shape Cognitive Health in Later Life.” *The Journals of Gerontology: Series B (Editor’s Choice)*.

Moorman, Sara and **Saber Khani**. 2024. “High School Curriculum and Cognitive Function in the Eighth Decade of Life.” *Alzheimer Disease & Associated Disorders* 38(3):235-240.

Khani, Saber and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. 2023. “Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019).” *Comparative Political Studies* 57(10):1668-1702. [Journal impact factor: 6.0. Rank in Discipline: 3]

Manuscripts Under Review

* graduate student co-authors
Ferati, Jalal*, **Saber Khani**, and Akash Chopra*. “From Presence to Prominence: Institutional Pathways and Women’s Appointments to Cabinets Across Regimes.” *Perspectives on Politics*. Revise & Resubmit.

Khani, Saber. “Drilling and Dissent: Oil, Corruption, and Contention - Evidence From a Dual-Level Analysis, 2005–2019.” *Social Problems*. Under review.

	Khani, Saber and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. “Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocratic Regimes.” <i>American Sociological Review</i>. Under review. Kadivar, Mohammad Ali and Saber Khani. “The Politics of War Commemoration in Iran.” <i>American Journal of Sociology</i>. Under review. Kadivar, Mohammad Ali, Saber Khani, Danial Vahabli, Vahid Abedini, and Samira Barzin. “The Contingency of Structures: Triggers and the Social Geography of Revolutionary Episodes in Iran 2018 - 2022.” <i>Social Forces</i>. Under review. Kadivar, Mohammad Ali, Saber Khani, Danial Vahabli. “Who Made the Iranian Revolution? Mobilization and Death, 1977–1979.” <i>American Political Science Review</i>. Under review. Kadivar, Mohammad Ali, Saber Khani. “Uneven Incorporation: Ethnic Inequality Across Social Domains in Iran.” <i>The Journal of Development Studies</i>. Under review.
Working Papers	Khani, Saber. “Smelling the Source: Oil Pollution, Sulfur Dioxide, and Targeted Protest in a Global Grid Cell Analysis, 2019–2024.” Manuscript ready for journal submission. Khani, Saber. “In the Shadow of Extraction: How Perceived Proximity to Oil Infrastructure Fuels Dissent.” Manuscript ready for journal submission.
Original Datasets	Saber Khani and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. 2023. “Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds: State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization Evidence from Iran (2015-2019).” <i>Harvard Dataverse, V1</i>. Mohammad Ali Kadivar and Saber Khani. “Islamic Republic Martyrs Dataset (IRMD) (1980-1988).” N = 214,000+ individuals. Saber Khani. “Petroprotest: Oil-Related Unarmed Protests Across 160 Countries (2005-2019).” N = 8000+ events. <i>Survey</i> Saber Khani. “Iraq National Survey (Feb–May 2025).” N = 750+ respondents across all 18 governorates. A comprehensive survey examines Iraqi citizens’ protest participation since 2015, perceptions of oil sector corruption and governance, and attitudes toward environmental impacts and economic policies. Saber Khani. “Basra City Survey (Mar–Apr 2025).” N = 500 participants from Basra city neighborhoods. This focused survey covers the same national topics while adding Basra-specific questions about proximity to oil infrastructure, local impacts of petroleum facilities on daily life, and comparative regional perspectives.
Other Writings	Mohammad Ali Kadivar, Peyman Jafari, Mehdi Hoseini, and Saber Khani. 2021. “Labor Organizing on the Rise Among Iranian Oil Workers.” <i>Middle East Report Online</i>. Mohammad Ali Kadivar, Saber Khani, and Abolfazl Sotoudeh. 2019. “Iran’s Protests Are Not Just About Gas Prices.” <i>Foreign Affairs</i>.

Fellowships and Awards	Young Scholars in Social Movements Mini-Conference (\$800) <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	Fall 2024
	Donald White Teaching Excellence Award (\$700) <i>Boston College</i>	Spring 2024
	Ivan Brown Research Grant (\$2,500) <i>Boston College</i>	Spring 2023
	Graduate Fellow at Clough Center for Democracy (\$5,000) <i>Boston College</i>	Fall 2022
	John B. Williamson Award (\$500) <i>Boston College</i>	Fall 2019
	Sociology Department Summer Research Fellowship (\$5,000) Summer 2020 & 2021 <i>Boston College</i>	
Conference Presentations	“Drilling and Dissent: Mapping Oil Governance, Corruption, and Contention as a Strategic Action Field” <i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>	Aug 2025, Chicago
	“Campus Co-opted: Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocratic Regimes” <i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>	Aug 2025, Chicago
	“Compliance on Campus: Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocracies” <i>American Political Science Association (APSA)</i>	Sep 2024, Philadelphia
	“Performative Representation: Gender, Regime Type, and Ministerial Appointments” <i>American Political Science Association (APSA)</i>	Sep 2024, Philadelphia
	“Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019)” <i>American Sociological Association (ASA)</i>	Aug 2023, Philadelphia
	“Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019)” <i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>	Aug 2023, Philadelphia
	“The Organizational Infrastructure of Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran 2015-2019” <i>TextXD</i>	Dec 2022, California
	“The Organizational Infrastructure of Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran 2015-2019” <i>Social Science History Association (SSHA)</i>	Nov 2022, Chicago
Research Experience	Research Assistant <i>Older Adult Social Participation, Gender, and Cognitive Decline Project</i> PI: Dr. Eric M. Vogelsang, California State University, San Bernardino Funded by National Institutes of Health (NIH) Support for Research Excellence (SuRE) Program (R16)	Fall 2023

Languages	<i>Coding:</i> R, Python, Stata, ArcGIS, L ^A T _E X	
	<i>Languages:</i> Farsi (Native), English (Advanced), Arabic (Intermediate), Turkish (Beginner)	
Teaching Experience	Boston College	
	<i>Instructor</i>	
	Introduction to Sociology	Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2024
	Student Evaluations: 4.6/5.0 (N = 113)	
	- Created and taught an engaging and comprehensive course focused on foundational sociological concepts. This course not only gave students a strong foundation in key theories and principles, but also guided them in applying sociological analysis to critically examine contemporary real-world issues in the US and global societies.	
	<i>Instructor</i>	
	Introduction to Statistics	Summer 2025, Summer 2026
	Student Evaluations: 3.8/5.0 (N = 25)	
	- Developed and delivered an intensive 6-week online asynchronous course that immersed students in fundamental statistical concepts. This course emphasized hands-on learning and equipped students with proficiency in Stata statistical software, helping them to manipulate, analyze, and visualize data effectively. Through engaging content and practical exercises, participants gained a deeper understanding of statistical methodologies and their real-world applications.	
	<i>Teaching Assistant</i>	
Academic Service	Introduction to Statistics	Fall 2019, Fall 2021, Spring 2021
	Introductory Sociology for Healthcare Professions	Spring 2020
	Referee	
	<i>American Journal of Sociology</i>	
	<i>Comparative Political Studies</i>	
References	<i>Conflict Management and Peace Science</i>	
	<i>ILR Review</i>	
	<i>Digest of Middle East Studies</i>	
	<i>Research on Aging</i>	
	Mohammad Ali Kadivar	Wen Fan
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